

ROLE

1. Passage anchor

> “...especially if I ever mentor younger students or work in a leadership **role**.”

Passage meaning

role = the function, position, or responsibility that someone has in a particular situation or organization

角色；**職責**；**職位功能**

Here:

a leadership role

= a position in which someone is responsible for guiding, influencing, or directing others

領導角色；**領導職責**；**具有領導責任的職位**

Practice

1. She gradually moved into a **leadership role**.

她逐漸進入了一個**領導角色 / 領導職位**。

2. Teachers often play an important **role** in building students' confidence.

老師常常在建立學生自信方面扮演重要**角色**。

Core meanings of ROLE

2. role — function or part someone has in a situation

= the function or part performed by a person in a particular activity, situation, or group

角色；**作用**；**職責**

Examples

1. Parents play an important **role** in a child's development.

父母在孩子的成長中扮演重要**角色**。

2. Everyone on the team has a clear **role**.

團隊中的每個人都有明確的**職責**。

This is one of the central everyday meanings.

3. play a role in something

= have an effect, function, or influence in something

****在.....中扮演角色；對.....起作用****

Examples

1. Confidence plays a major ****role**** in public speaking.

自信在公開演講中扮演重要****角色****。

2. Diet can play a ****role**** in overall health.

飲食可能對整體健康****產生作用****。

Very high-value pattern.

4. play an important / major / key role

= be especially important in causing, supporting, or influencing something

****扮演重要 / 主要 / 關鍵角色****

Examples

1. Communication plays a ****key role**** in teamwork.

溝通在團隊合作中扮演****關鍵角色****。

2. Technology has played a ****major role**** in changing how people work.

科技在改變人們工作方式方面扮演了****重要角色****。

Job / organizational function

5. role — job function or position

= a particular function or set of responsibilities within an organization

****職務；職責；職位角色****

Examples

1. She applied for a new ****role**** in the company.

她申請了公司裡的一個新****職位****。

2. His ****role**** involves training new staff.

他的**職務**包括培訓新員工。

In business English, **role** is often broader than a job title.

6. leadership role

= a position involving responsibility for guiding or directing others

領導角色；領導職責

Examples

1. She took on a **leadership role** in the project.

她在專案中承擔了**領導職責**。

2. He hopes to move into a **leadership role** in the future.

他希望未來能進入一個**領導職位**。

This is the exact passage use.

7. take on a role

= accept or begin performing a particular function or responsibility

承擔角色；接下職責

Examples

1. She **took on the role of mentor**.

她**承擔起導師的角色**。

2. He **took on a more senior role** last year.

他去年**接下了一個更資深的職位**。

8. assume a role

= formally or deliberately begin performing a role

擔任；承擔

Examples

1. She **assumed the role of team leader**.

她**擔任團隊領導者的角色**。

2. He **assumed a supervisory role**.
他開始**擔任監督職務**。

More formal than **take on a role**.

9. fulfill / perform a role

= carry out the responsibilities of a role

履行角色 / 職責

Examples

1. She **fulfilled her role** effectively.
她有效地**履行了自己的職責**。
2. Each department **performs a different role**.
每個部門都**執行不同的功能**。

Social role

10. social role

= expected pattern of behavior associated with a person's position in society or a group

社會角色

Examples

1. People often perform several different **social roles**.
人們往往同時扮演多種不同的**社會角色**。
2. Ideas about gender **roles** have changed over time.
人們對性別**角色**的觀念隨時間改變。

11. family role

= function or expected position within a family

家庭角色

Examples

1. Family **roles** can change after a major life event.
重大人生事件後，家庭**角色**可能會改變。
2. He struggled to balance his work and family **roles**.
他很難平衡工作與家庭**角色**。

Acting / performance

12. role — character played by an actor

= the part of a fictional character performed by an actor
角色

Examples

1. She played the **role** of a teacher.
她飾演一位老師的**角色**。
2. He was offered the leading **role** in the film.
他獲邀出演電影的**主角角色**。

This is a major distinct meaning.

13. play a role

In acting:

= perform a character in a play, film, etc.
扮演角色

Examples

1. She **played the role of Juliet**.
她**飾演茱麗葉**。
2. He has played several comic **roles**.
他演過好幾個喜劇**角色**。

14. lead role

= main acting part in a film, play, etc.

****主角；主要角色****

Examples

1. She got the ****lead role**** in the play.
她得到了這齣戲的****主角****。
2. He is best known for a ****lead role**** in a television drama.
他最為人熟知的是一部電視劇中的****主要角色****。

15. supporting role

= important but secondary acting part

****配角****

Examples

1. He won an award for best ****supporting role****.
他以最佳****配角****獲獎。
2. She appears in a ****supporting role****.
她以****配角****身分出演。

Function of things, institutions, or factors

16. role — function or purpose of something

= the function something has in a system, process, or situation

****作用；功能****

Examples

1. Water plays an essential ****role**** in the body.
水在人體中發揮重要****作用****。
2. The committee's ****role**** is to provide advice.
這個委員會的****功能 / 職責****是提供建議。

17. role in causing / preventing something

= contribution to a particular outcome

****在造成 / 防止某事方面的作用****

Examples

1. Stress may play a ****role in causing**** sleep problems.
壓力可能在造成睡眠問題方面發揮一定****作用****。

2. Education has a ****role in preventing**** misinformation.
教育在防止錯誤資訊方面具有一定****作用****。

Responsibility / expected behavior

18. someone's role is to...

= someone's responsibility or function is to do something

****某人的職責是.....****

Examples

1. My ****role is to support the team****.
我的****職責是支持團隊****。

2. A mentor's ****role is to guide, not control****.
導師的****角色是引導，而不是控制****。

Very useful structure.

19. know your role

= understand what your responsibilities or function are

****了解自己的角色 / 職責****

Examples

1. Everyone needs to ****know their role****.
每個人都需要****清楚自己的職責****。

2. Clear teams work better when members ****know their roles****.

當成員清楚自己的**角色分工**時，團隊通常運作得更好。

Importance / influence

20. have a role in something

= be involved in or partly responsible for something

在.....中有作用 / 參與

Examples

1. Genetics may **have a role in** the condition.
遺傳因素可能在這種情況中**起一定作用**。
2. Several factors **had a role in** the final decision.
幾個因素都對最終決定**產生了作用**。

21. role in shaping something

= function or influence in determining how something develops

在塑造.....方面的作用

Examples

1. Teachers have an important **role in shaping confidence**.
老師在**塑造自信**方面扮演重要角色。
2. Culture plays a major **role in shaping attitudes**.
文化在**塑造態度**方面發揮重大作用。

This links especially well with the passage.

Role reversal / exchange

22. role reversal

= situation in which people exchange their usual roles

角色互換

Examples

1. The story involves an interesting **role reversal**.

這個故事包含有趣的**角色互換**。

2. Caring for an aging parent can sometimes create a **role reversal**.

照顧年老父母有時會形成**角色互換**。

23. reverse roles

= exchange responsibilities or positions

互換角色

Examples

1. The students **reversed roles** halfway through the exercise.

學生們在練習做到一半時**互換角色**。

2. Imagine that the two characters **reversed roles**.

想像這兩個角色**互換身分**。

Role-playing

24. role-play — noun

= activity in which people act out particular roles or situations

角色扮演；情境演練

Examples

1. We practiced interviews through **role-play**.

我們透過**角色扮演**練習面試。

2. The lesson included a customer-service **role-play**.

課堂中包含一個客服情境的**角色扮演練習**。

25. role-play — verb

= act out a situation by taking particular roles

進行角色扮演

Examples

1. Students **role-played** a job interview.
學生們**角色扮演**了一場求職面試。
2. Let's **role-play** the conversation first.
我們先把這段對話**用角色扮演演練一次**。

26. role-playing

= the activity of acting out roles; also used in games
角色扮演

Examples

1. **Role-playing** can improve speaking confidence.
角色扮演可以提升口語自信。
2. She enjoys **role-playing games**.
她喜歡**角色扮演遊戲**。

Related compounds

27. role model

= a person whose behavior or qualities others admire and may imitate
榜樣；模範人物

Examples

1. Her teacher became a **role model** for her.
她的老師成了她的**榜樣**。
2. Young people need positive **role models**.
年輕人需要正面的**榜樣**。

Very relevant to the passage's theme of influence.

28. role model vs mentor

****role model****

= someone you admire and may imitate

****榜樣****

****mentor****

= someone who actively guides and advises you

****導師；指導者****

A person can be both.

Grammar / countability

29. role is countable

Correct:

* a role

* one role

* several roles

* different roles

Examples

1. She has several ****roles**** in the organization.

她在組織裡有幾個不同的****角色 / 職責****。

2. He took on a new ****role****.

他承擔了一個新的****職務角色****。

Key contrasts

30. role vs job

****job****

= paid position or employment

****工作；職位****

****role****

= function or responsibilities within a job or situation

****角色；職責****

Compare:

> Her **job** is project manager.

> 她的工作是專案經理。

> Her **role** is to coordinate different teams.

> 她的**職責**是協調不同團隊。

A single job may contain several roles.

31. role vs position

position

= official place or job within an organization

職位；職務

role

= what that person actually does or is responsible for

角色；職責

Compare:

> He accepted a senior **position**.

> 他接受了一個高階**職位**。

> His **role** includes mentoring junior staff.

> 他的**職責**包括指導初階員工。

32. role vs responsibility

responsibility

= specific duty or obligation

責任；職責

role

= broader function that may include several responsibilities

角色；職能

Example:

> My **role** is team leader.

> 我的角色是團隊領導者。

> One of my **responsibilities** is giving feedback.

> 我的其中一項職責是提供回饋。

33. role vs function

function

= purpose or practical operation of someone or something

功能；作用

role

= part played within a broader situation or system

角色；作用

For machines and systems, **function** is often more technical.

For people and social situations, **role** is often more natural.

34. role vs character

In fiction:

character

= fictional person

人物；角色

role

= the part performed by an actor

角色；所飾演的部分

Compare:

> Hamlet is a **character**.

> 哈姆雷特是一個故事人物。

> The actor played the **role** of Hamlet.

> 那位演員飾演哈姆雷特這個角色。

35. role vs influence

role

= part or function in producing an outcome

****作用****

****influence****

= effect on how someone or something develops

****影響****

Compare:

> Teachers play an important ****role**** in education.

> 老師在教育中扮演重要角色。

> Teachers have a strong ****influence**** on students.

> 老師對學生有很大的影響。

Meaning map

The central concept of ****role**** is:

****the part someone or something plays within a larger situation****

From this develop several branches:

Social / organizational function

leadership role

→ ****角色；職責****

Job function

new role at work

→ ****職務；職位功能****

Causal contribution

play a role in something

→ ****發揮作用****

Acting

play a role in a film

→ ****飾演角色****

Expected social behavior

social role

→ **社會角色**

Training

role-play

→ **角色扮演**

Influence through example

role model

→ **榜樣**

The common thread is always:

****a particular part, function, or position within a larger whole.****

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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role — general function	某人在特定情況、群體或活動中所承擔的功能、部分或職責
play a role in something	對某件事的發展、結果或運作產生作用 / 影響
play a key/major role	在某件事中發揮特別重要或關鍵的作用
role — job function	在組織中負責的特定職務、功能或責任範圍
leadership role	需要帶領、影響或指導他人的領導職責 / 職位
take on / assume a role	開始承擔某項角色、功能或責任
fulfill / perform a role	實際履行某項角色所包含的職責
social role	社會或群體中與某種身分相關的預期行為與功能
role — acting	演員在戲劇、電影等作品中所飾演的角色
lead role	作品中的主要演出角色；主角
supporting role	次於主角的重要演出角色；配角
role — function of a thing/institution	某事物、機構或因素在整體系統中的功能或作用
someone's role is to...	某人的主要職責 / 功能是做.....
role reversal	原本不同的人交換彼此通常的角色或責任
role-play	為練習或模擬情境而扮演特定角色
role model	行為、品格或成就值得他人學習模仿的人；榜樣

Passage recap

> “...if I ever mentor younger students or work in a leadership **role**.”

Here:

role = **a position or function involving particular responsibilities**

More specifically:

leadership role

= **a role in which someone guides, influences, or directs others**

Best Traditional Chinese renderings:

* **領導角色**

* **領導職責**

* **具有領導責任的職位**

Natural contextual translation:

如果將來我有機會指導年輕學生，或擔任需要領導他人的職位.....

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

role in **“leadership role”**

= **a particular function or position with specific responsibilities**

角色；職責；職位功能

It does **not** mean an acting role here.